

Best Practices for Writing Clean HTML

A practical checklist for readable, maintainable, accessible, and well-organized HTML.

1. Use Proper Indentation

Indent nested elements for better readability.

```
<ul>
  <li>Item 1</li>
  <li>Item 2</li>
</ul>
```

2. Always Close Your Tags

Even if some tags are optional, it's best to close them properly.

```
<p>This is correct.</p>
```

3. Use Meaningful Tag Structure

Use semantic tags like `<header>`, `<main>`, and `<footer>` instead of relying only on `<div>`.

Example: Organizing page areas

```
<!-- Navigation -->
<nav>...</nav>

<!-- Main Content -->
<main>...</main>
```

4. Include alt Text for Images

Include **alt** text for images. This improves accessibility and helps screen readers understand image content.

```

```

5. Use Lowercase for Tags and Attributes

HTML is not case-sensitive, but using lowercase is the standard.

```
<!-- Good -->
<input type="text">

<!-- Avoid -->
<INPUT TYPE="TEXT">
```

6. Organize Your Code

Keep your HTML structured by grouping related elements together. Use comments to separate sections.

```
<!-- Navigation -->
<nav>...</nav>

<!-- Main Content -->
<main>...</main>
```

7. Don't Use Inline Styles (if possible)

Avoid putting CSS styles directly into HTML tags. Use external CSS files instead.

```
<!-- Avoid -->
<p style="color: red;">Red text</p>

<!-- Prefer -->
<p class="red-text">Red text</p>
```

8. Validate Your HTML

Use tools like the W3C HTML Validator to check for errors in your code.

9. Keep File Names Simple and Clear

Use lowercase letters, dashes instead of spaces, and meaningful names.

```
✓ about-us.html
✗ About Us!.html
```

10. Comment Your Code (When Needed)

Use comments to explain complex sections or to label page areas.

```
<!-- Contact Form -->
<form>...</form>
```

■ Tip

- Clean HTML is easier to read, debug, maintain, and scale as your website grows.

Quick Takeaway

Write HTML with consistent indentation, clear structure, meaningful semantic elements, useful image **alt** text, lowercase tags and attributes, organized sections, minimal inline styling, validated markup, simple filenames, and comments where they add value.